

City Air Makes You Free

(if you are upper class or financially satisfied)

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We test hypothesis that cities are more free, and we do not find support for it except in Middle East/North Africa. If anything, there is some support of the contrary—greater freedom/autonomy in smaller places. But overall it is a mix and varies by region and country. East Asia/Pacific stands out with high effect sizes at about .4 or even .5, also controlling for other predictors of freedom. South Asia stands out as having large positive effect .3-.4 in the smallest category ($< 2k$). In particular in many regions or countries there is more freedom v large cities $> 500k$ in large towns mid-sized cities of $100 - 500k$ and $50 - 100k$ but slightly less in the smallest places $< 2k$. The effect sizes are large of about 4 steps on 1-10 income scale.

City life and Gesellschaft down the common people to decay and death. Ferdinand Toennies

In the city and therefore, where general conditions characteristic of the Gesellschaft prevail, only the upper strata, the rich and the cultured, are really active and alive. Ferdinand Toennies

City air makes you free (Stadt Luft macht frei) (Park et al. [1925] 1984, p. 12) originated in the Middle Ages, and it meant freedom from feudalism in cities, non-feudal islands in a sea of feudalism (Harvey 2012).

The parallel is somewhat a stretch (and the title is hook bait). The original saying was in Middle Ages and referred to freedom from feudalism in cities. Feudalism is long gone, although we may have techno feudalism (cite), but the idea does remain that cities are still more free than ruralities, especially for non-conformist types such as LGBTQ.

Some authors use term freedom (Okulicz-Kozaryn 2014) and some autonomy (Steckermeier 2022)—we use the terms interchangeably.

We test hypothesis that cities are more free, and we do not find support for it except in Middle East/North Africa. If anything, there is some support of the contrary—greater freedom/autonomy in smaller places.

It'd be already finding that ppl don't have more autonomy in cities, bc there are reasons and arguments that they do. And it is counterintuitive, city, just as the US appears the land of the free, but it is not. But I also have the case why there would be less autonomy in the city, just as there would be less in the West (especially the US) v Latin America—Mexico, Colombia and Venezuela are some of the most free countries in the World (Okulicz-Kozaryn 2014, Okulicz-Kozaryn and Martinez 2025). City (and the US) is stressed hectic anxious materialistic and consumerist (Okulicz-Kozaryn 2015) and overstimulating (Simmel 1903, Lederbogen et al. 2011)—in such conditions autonomy is difficult.

Freedom/autonomy can be counterintuitive—for instance the US advertises itself as “the land of the free” and yet people in the US feel less free at 7.7 than Mexicans and Colombians at above 8.1. Likewise, city may seem more free than ruralities, but as this paper argues usually that's not the case.

In the US v Latin America there is more social pressure,¹ and so a person in the US is more of an “automaton” (to use Fromm's term) (Okulicz-Kozaryn 2014).

¹Also see a fantastic book by Frank (2012) on keeping up with the Joneses in the US.

What is freedom/autonomy?² To be free is to be able to choose, to control and direct one's own life. Freedom is having control—a person is free if she is her own master. It could be labelled “psychological freedom:” “Freedom means a degree of harmony between basic motives and overt behavior” (Bay 1970, p.83 cited in Okulicz-Kozaryn 2014). It is “capability to choose,” “awareness of alternatives” and “courage to choose” (Veenhoven 2000).³ Clearly, there are more choices in city v ruralities, so at least in a sense more freedom. But then too much choice may also backfire and even lead to a paralysis (Schwartz 2004).

1 Literature

leonie help!

There are theoretical reasons to expect more freedom in cities v ruralities. In rurality there is mechanical solidarity—rural folks function like parts of a simple machine—groups are held together through homogeneity and similarity: similar lifestyles, roles, shared values and morality. Ruralities force social conformity not conducive for individual freedom (Durkheim [1893] 1997). Organic solidarity in cities allows for more differentiation and individualism. Likewise, there would be more *Gemeinschaft* in ruralities—more collective and social that may restrict personal freedom; and more *Gesellschaft* in urban that may promote individualism (but also hostility and aggression). Finally, Simmel observed that as urbanism overloads a person it forces a person to distance herself from the environment (Simmel 1903), which also may be conducive for differentiation and individualism. Urbanites are also more tolerant (Tuch 1987).

Many studies approach freedom as predictor of subjective wellbeing, but freedom is also an end itself (Okulicz-Kozaryn 2014), as recognized by Fromm (2013, 2012, 1992, 1964, 1944, [1941] 1994), Sen (2000). The Universal Declaration of Human Rights states that freedom is a human right: freedom for the realization of one's human potential (art. 26, 29).

There are many studies on the effect of urban-rural on subjective wellbeing (SWB) (e.g., Sørensen 2024, 2014, Knies 2026, Okulicz-Kozaryn and Valente 2021), but the effect of urban-rural on freedom has only been studied once.

There are studies on freedom using WVS (e.g., Okulicz-Kozaryn 2014, Pitlik 2016, Nikolaev and Bennett 2016), but they do not examine urbanicity. The only such paper is Yamagishi et al. (2012), including among the papers that cite it.

Yamagishi et al. (2012) tests the “city air” hypothesis: the social constraints prevalent in rural life are weaker in metropolitan areas, freeing metropolitan residents from pressure to suppress their pursuit of individual goals. Yet their test is very different from ours—they show that urbanites are more likely to choose extravagant pens than rural folks. Still, the study is useful in at least 2 ways. First they show that indeed there is more freedom in city (using extravagant pens test), and they provide theory and literature summarized in the next paragraph.

Cities provide freedom from traditional rural social constraints—*Gesellschaft* v *Gemeinschaft*—deviation from community norms is more likely to be reprimanded and ostracized in rural v urban. An urbanite may be more internally driven rather than externally constrained rural folk. City provides more opportunities for alternative jobs and social relations, so urbanite is more free by being less concerned about social exclusion. Also see discussion in Luca et al. (2023).

One mechanism is higher social pressure for conformity in ruralities—cities provide anonymity—indeed concern for moral reputation is greater in rural than urban areas (Danielson et al 2023 cited in Okulicz-Kozaryn 2026). The higher the population density, the lower the frequency of social comparison measuring social comparison with searches on Google (Okulicz-Kozaryn 2026).

²Here we focus on personal as opposed to societal freedom and follow Okulicz-Kozaryn (2014).

³The degree of perceived control over choice is called “locus of control” in psychology and Verme (2009) argues that WVS item used here measures locus of control in addition to freedom.

2 Data and model

All data come from World Values Survey (WVS). WVS is a fantastic and free dataset available from <https://www.worldvaluessurvey.org>. It is a great source of data as compared to \$30k+ closed source Gallup data. It is helpful to use open source public data amidst corporatization of research and academia (?????).

WVS is representative of each country. Countries in the sample and sample sizes are shown in table ??

Autonomy/freedom variable reads "Some people feel they have completely free choice and control over their lives, while other people feel that what they do has no real effect on what happens to them. Please use this scale where 1 means 'none at all' and 10 means 'a great deal' to indicate how much freedom of choice and control you feel you have over the way your life turns out."

Validity and reliability of the measure seem fine and have been used successfully in the literature (e.g., Verme 2009, Inglehart et al. 2008, Veenhoven 2000, Okulicz-Kozaryn 2014) but still the question may be interpreted slightly differently in different languages/cultures, and some caution would be useful.

Other variables are listed in appendix and there also shown distributions of all variables TODO

We use World Bank regions classification into several regions: East Asia/Pacific, Europe/Central Asia, Latin America/Caribbean, Middle East/North Africa, North America, South Asia, and Sub-Saharan Africa. Countries in each region and sample sizes are in appendix.

Per controls we follow Pitlik (2016) except that we use financial satisfaction in most specifications instead of income as it arguably predicts freedom more than income and indeed in our sample correlates higher, and also we don't use their country level democracy index, and PCGDP in appendix only. Likewise, we have all person level predictors that Nikolaev and Bennett (2016) have used.

Money is important for freedom. Indeed as many financial gurus on YouTube would tell you freedom is the only or main reason to accumulate wealth in the first place. For instance, the FIRE movement (Financial Independence, Retire Early) is all about freedom/autonomy. Hence in our analyses we will focus on income, class and financial satisfaction. Financial satisfaction is the key—not everyone needs the same amount of money to be financially satisfied. It is measured as "How satisfied are you with the financial situation of your household?"

In addition we add crime victimization and fear of crime: "Have you been the victim of a crime during the past year?" and "In the last 12 months, how often have you or your family: Felt unsafe from crime in your own home"

3 Results

4 By region

First for all regions in general there is more freedom in smaller areas v top bin, the base case ($> 500k$) in table 1 but controlling for other predictors in table 2 it is just the 2nd (2-5k) and 3rd (5-10k) smallest categories, and smaller values in 6th and 7th categories. But the very smallest areas ($< 2k$) are not more free. Next we separate by region.

East Asia/Pacific stands out with high effect sizes at about .4 or even .5, also controlling for other predictors of freedom. Europe is mostly less free in smaller areas. Latin America/Caribbean stands out with negative effect in the very smallest areas. Middle East/North Africa has mostly negative effects. North America is positive in 2nd largest category (100-500k). South Asia and Sub-Saharan Africa mostly do not show significant differences.⁴

⁴Except -0.54 for Sub-Saharan Africa in 7th bin (100-500k).

	All region dummies	(with dummies)	East Asia/Pacific	Europe/Central Asia	Latin America/Caribbean	Middle East/North Africa	North America	South Asia	Sub-Saharan Africa
town==2k	-0.05+		0.05	-0.13*	-0.28***	0.22	-0.07	0.01	-0.29
town==2-5k	0.14***		0.36***	0.09	-0.13	-0.09	-0.07	0.02	0.06
town==5-10k	0.20***		0.51***	0.03	-0.01	-0.12	0.13	0.03	0.35
town==10-20k	0.09**		0.52***	-0.15**	0.07	-0.34***	-0.03	-0.02	0.19
town==20-50k	0.12***		0.28***	0.08+	0.08	-0.17*	0.09	0.03	-0.22
town==50-100k	0.12***		0.41***	-0.10+	0.04	-0.02	0.12	-0.41+	-0.06
town==100-500k	0.08***		0.55***	-0.12**	-0.08+	-0.27***	0.18**	0.04	-0.45+
constant	6.94***		6.76***	7.06***	7.85***	6.88***	7.44***	7.52***	7.14***
N	93414		24560	25289	17285	9846	5833	5907	4694

+ 0.10 * 0.05 **
0.01 *** 0.001; robust std err

Table 1: OLS regressions of freedom/agency

	All region dummies	(with dummies)	East Asia/Pacific	Europe/Central Asia	Latin America/Caribbean	Middle East/North Africa	North America	South Asia	Sub-Saharan Africa
town==2k	-0.04		0.03	-0.11*	-0.18**	0.04	-0.07	0.21	-0.30
town==2-5k	0.08**		0.29***	-0.06	-0.16+	-0.10	-0.10	0.21	0.04
town==5-10k	0.10**		0.37***	-0.01	-0.05	-0.16*	-0.02	0.08	0.17
town==10-20k	0.01		0.43***	-0.26***	-0.03	-0.35***	-0.01	0.21	0.02
town==20-50k	0.01		0.25***	-0.06	-0.05	-0.24***	0.04	-0.06	-0.31
town==50-100k	0.05+		0.34***	-0.25***	-0.03	-0.05	0.14+	0.02	-0.14
town==100-500k	0.06**		0.49***	-0.18***	-0.03	-0.30***	0.13*	0.02	-0.54*
trust	0.01		0.08**	-0.01	-0.13*	-0.05	0.14***	-0.12	-0.73***
age	0.01***		0.01*	0.00	0.02**	0.00	0.03***	0.03	0.02
age2	-0.00***		-0.00**	-0.00	-0.00*	0.00	-0.00**	-0.00	-0.00
male	0.00		-0.09**	0.05	-0.10**	0.22***	-0.11**	0.18*	0.12
married or living together as married	-0.01		-0.00	-0.06+	-0.05	0.02	-0.02	0.05	0.26*
Full time	0.00		0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
Part time	-0.09**		-0.03	-0.08	-0.23***	-0.03	0.08	-0.22*	-0.01
Self employed	-0.06*		-0.11**	0.09	-0.05	-0.06	0.36***	-0.47***	0.14
Retired	-0.00		0.16**	-0.08	0.04	0.29**	-0.05	-0.29	-0.14
Housewife	-0.22***		-0.19***	-0.18**	-0.07	-0.17*	-0.04	-0.54***	-0.22
Students	-0.21***		-0.22***	-0.07	-0.28***	-0.18+	0.05	-0.25	-0.07
Unemployed	-0.10**		-0.09	-0.15*	-0.03	-0.12	-0.11	-0.26+	0.14
Other	-0.22**		-0.22	-0.31*	-0.00	-0.20	-0.01	-1.84***	1.56**
financial satisfaction	0.26***		0.30***	0.29***	0.18***	0.30***	0.25***	0.31***	0.09***
health	0.33***		0.30***	0.24***	0.36***	0.44***	0.49***	0.20***	0.24***
How many children do you have	0.04***		-0.01	0.04**	0.02	0.10***	0.06**	0.04	-0.09*
religion important	0.07***		0.10***	0.02	0.02	0.35***	0.11***	0.15**	0.19+
freq felt unsafe from crime at home	-0.13***		-0.13***	-0.23***	-0.08***	-0.03	-0.17***	-0.19***	-0.23***
victim of a crime last year	-0.13***		-0.11*	-0.16*	-0.03	-0.38***	-0.17*	0.13	-0.25*
constant	3.82***		3.45***	4.71***	5.06***	2.05***	3.28***	3.75***	5.07***
N	85059		22995	20892	16430	9280	5765	5118	4579

+ 0.10 * 0.05 **
0.01 *** 0.001; robust std err

Table 2: OLS regressions of freedom/agency

5 By country

In table 3 we repeat full model from table 2 separately for each countries. We collapse urbanicity to just 3 categories lt20k, 20-500k, and gt500k so that the sample sizes do not run too small. Still note that few countries lack the estimates as even this simplified 3 step urbanicity spectrum is not available. Overall it is a mix some countries one way some another, and many insignificant, but many more negative than positive. So in general within countries less freedom in smaller areas. Latin countries have lower freedom in smaller areas: ARG, BOL, CHL, NIC, PER South Asia does not have a clear pattern: BGD is positive, but IND highly negative. Europe/Central Asia: many insignificant, but otherwise mostly negative: CYP, KAZ, TJK, and TUR; and positive: ROU East Asia/Pacific stood out earlier as mostly positive, but here: negative: highly positive THA, but negative JPN, MYS and several countries in East Asia/Pacific are without respondents in smaller areas: HKG, KOR, MAC, SGP, and VNM Middle East/North Africa positive: MAR; negative: IRQ, LBN

Sub-Saharan Africa: ETH Negative but ZWE positive

	lt20k	20-500k	N
AND	-0.18	0.00	992
ARG	-0.55*	-0.31	798
ARM	0.19	-0.06	1181
AUS	0.05	0.01	1552
BGD	0.36*	0.00	1189
BOL	-0.26*	-0.25*	1964
BRA	-0.29	-0.04	1637
CAN	0.05	0.08	4018
CHL	-0.35	-0.54*	861
CHN	-0.07	0.00	2747
COL	0.07	0.05	1520
CYP	-0.67*	0.00	871
CZE	-0.02	0.04	1176
DEU	0.21	0.29+	1443
ECU	0.06	0.04	1158
EGY	-0.14	-0.01	1168
ETH	-1.07+	-1.38*	1205
GRC	-0.05	0.09	1148
GTM	-0.08	-0.03	1102
HKG			2035
IDN	0.24	0.38	3151
IND	-0.64*	-1.10*	1029
IRN	0.13	0.14	1471
IRQ	-0.06	-0.39*	1128
JOR	0.07	0.09	1185
JPN	-0.33	-0.31*	1062
KAZ	-0.36*	-0.27	1038
KEN	-0.41	-0.18	988
KGZ	-0.16	-0.03	1107
KOR		-0.05	1245
LBN	-0.65*	-0.40*	1200
LBY	0.12	-0.38*	905
MAC			747
MAR	0.55*	0.28*	1200
MDV	0.13	0.00	989
MEX	-0.12	-0.07	1617
MMR	-0.28	0.00	1200
MNG	-0.08	0.24+	1625
MYS	-0.38*	-0.21	1313
NGA	0.37	-0.18	1192
NIC	-0.42+	-0.19	1200
NLD	0.03	-0.18	1567
NZL	0.08	0.08	777
PAK	0.20	-0.05	1911
PER	-0.70*	-0.35+	1378
PHL	-0.03	0.00	1195
PRI	0.12	0.00	1051
ROU	0.62*	0.55*	1048
RUS	-0.18	-0.02	1618
SGP			1953
SRB	-0.25	-0.29	961
SVK	-0.09	0.00	1154
THA	1.21*	1.54*	1193
TJK	-0.42*	-0.31	1200
TUN	-0.11	0.17	1023
TUR	-0.67*	-0.46*	2291
TWN	0.89	0.88	1221
UKR	-0.05	0.17	1071
URY	-0.02	0.17	957
USA		-0.08	1747
UZB			1026
VEN	0.01	-0.23	1187
VNM		0.23	1200
ZWE	0.45*	0.00	1194

+ 0.10 * 0.05 ** 0.01 *** 0.001; robust
std err

Table 3: OLS regressions of freedom/agency using model ??

5.1 With country dummies

Here we conduct important sensitivity/robustness checks. First in a1 just urbanicity dummies. Then a1a adds region dummies like earlier in the first table 1 little change. A1b has income level dummies TODO spell out; again little change; but addition of country dummies in a1c kills the significance and turns many categories negative notably the first smallest one, similar with controls in models a2* and country dummies make categories even more negative in a2c than in a1c.

in table 4 we conduct additional robustness checks, a1 and a2 are repeated from the body; a1a and a2a include region dummies: in a1a 100 – 500k results are attenuated, but others are stronger; and in a2a the top three categories spanning 20 – 500k are weaker but other categories are stronger and the smaller category < 2k positive effect goes away. But then in a1b and a2b addition of country

dummies kills the effects unfortunately.

	a1	a1a	a1b	a1c	a2	a2a	a2b	a2c
town==2k	-0.03	-0.05+	-0.03	-0.07*	-0.07*	-0.04	-0.07*	-0.09**
town==2-5k	0.08**	0.14***	0.10**	-0.05	0.02	0.08**	0.03	-0.06+
town==5-10k	0.16***	0.20***	0.16***	0.00	0.07*	0.10**	0.06*	-0.04
town==10-20k	0.03	0.09**	0.02	-0.12***	-0.02	0.01	-0.02	-0.12***
town==20-50k	0.14***	0.12***	0.13***	-0.02	0.06*	0.01	0.05*	-0.06*
town==50-100k	0.13***	0.12***	0.11***	-0.01	0.10***	0.05+	0.09**	-0.03
town==100-500k	0.13***	0.08***	0.11***	-0.02	0.12***	0.06**	0.09***	-0.04+
trust					-0.06***	0.01	-0.06***	0.03
age					0.01*	0.01***	0.00	0.02***
age2					-0.00**	-0.00***	-0.00*	-0.00***
male					0.02	0.00	0.02	0.01
married or living together as mar- ried					-0.08***	-0.01	-0.07***	0.00
Full time					0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
Part time					-0.08**	-0.09**	-0.08**	-0.08**
Self employed					0.02	-0.06*	0.03	-0.01
Retired					0.03	-0.00	0.02	-0.04
Housewife					-0.16***	-0.22***	-0.16***	-0.21***
Students					-0.18***	-0.21***	-0.18***	-0.14***
Unemployed					-0.01	-0.10**	0.00	-0.10**
Other					-0.04	-0.22**	-0.01	-0.23**
financial satisfac- tion					0.27***	0.26***	0.27***	0.25***
health					0.34***	0.33***	0.34***	0.33***
How many chil- dren do you have					0.07***	0.04***	0.07***	0.02*
religion important					0.07***	0.07***	0.07***	0.04***
freq felt unsafe from crime at home					-0.05***	-0.13***	-0.05***	-0.11***
victim of a crime last year					0.02	-0.13***	0.01	-0.11***
region dummies	no	yes	no	no	no	yes	no	no
income level dum- mies	no	no	yes	no	no	no	yes	no
country dummies	no	no	no	yes	no	no	no	yes
constant	7.14***	6.94***	7.14***	7.57***	3.97***	3.82***	4.01***	4.21***
N	95083	93414	93414	95083	86280	85059	85059	86280

+ 0.10 * 0.05 **
0.01 *** 0.001; ro-
bust std err

Table 4: OLS regressions of freedom/agency

5.2 Interactions with financial satisfaction, class, and income

so then to probe further w try interactions with financial satisfactuion, striongest correlate of freedom (TODO double check and report at the beginnig of the results) and also related class and income. results are interesting–urbanicity categories are significant again even with country dummies (double check and report in appendix) and so are the interactonbs.

Urb rural is a gradient (Okulicz-Kozaryn 2017), but here for simplicity we we use $\geq 500k$ v small $\leq 10k$ (full gradient results in appendix) $\geq 500k$ represents city–indeed it could even be bigger than 500k–urban unhappiness appears around several hundred thousand (Okulicz-Kozaryn 2017).

By far the most differences are by financial satisfaction in panel a, those in top 3 categories are at about 8 v middle 3 at slightly above 7 v bottom 4 at below 6.5. For the bottom categories there is very slight decrease from rural to urban, and for the middle and upper financial satisfaction categories there is a slight increase from rural to urban The other 2 in panels b and c, class and income dont matter that much income 3rd and 4th more free, but the top 5th less free TODO more interpretation and beautify the graph

Regressions are in appendix in table ??

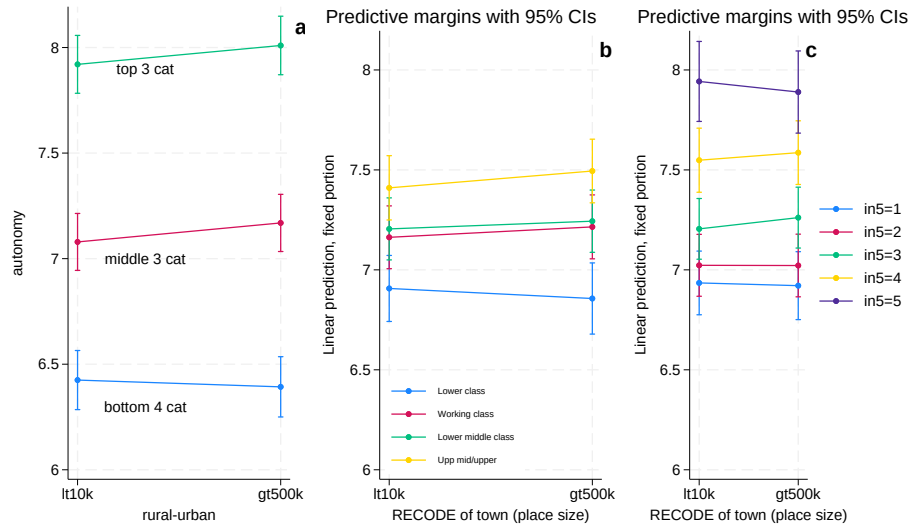


Figure 1: from table ?? in appendix

todo say what we contrl for like which spec from which table from earlier sec; and actual reg tables to appendix

6 Discussion and Conclusion

We find support for Toennies' idea: "in the city and therefore, where general conditions characteristic of the Gesellschaft prevail, only the upper strata, the rich and the cultured, are really active and alive" (Tönnies [1887] 2002, p. 227).

We test hypothesis that cities are more free, and we do not find support for it except in Middle East/North Africa. If anything, there is some support of the contrary—greater freedom/autonomy in smaller places. But overall it is a mix and varies by region and country. An interesting nuance is lower freedom for the smallest places $< 2k$ in Latin America/Caribbean. In particular in many regions or countries there is more freedom v large cities $> 500k$ in large towns midsize cities of $100 - 500k$ and $50 - 100k$ but slightly less in the smallest places $< 2k$. The effect sizes are large of about 4 steps on 1-10 income scale.

Like in Okulicz-Kozaryn (2024) urbanites probably actually have in a way fuller and more free life, but perhaps they realize more that they miss out relatively to other urbanites, and so they feel relatively less free. One mechanism could be that people tend to compare upwards (Frey and Stutzer 2002) and there are more people to compare to in urban areas, inequality ladders are taller and the pond is bigger—often it feels better to be big fish in a small pond (rural area).

ONLINE APPENDIX (SOM)

[note: this section will NOT be a part of the final version of the manuscript, but will be available online instead as SOM 'Supplementary Online Material']

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1 Additional info

1.1 Countries in each region and sample sizes

. bys region: ta cc				

-> regionname =				
ISO 3166-1				
alpha-3				
country				
code		Freq.	Percent	Cum.

NIR		447	26.77	26.77
TWN		1,223	73.23	100.00

Total		1,670	100.00	

-> regionname = East Asia/Pacific				
ISO 3166-1				
alpha-3				
country				
code		Freq.	Percent	Cum.

AUS		1,813	7.29	7.29
CHN		3,036	12.21	19.50
HKG		2,075	8.35	27.85
IDN		3,200	12.87	40.72
JPN		1,353	5.44	46.16
KOR		1,245	5.01	51.16
MAC		1,023	4.11	55.28
MMR		1,200	4.83	60.10
MNG		1,638	6.59	66.69
MYS		1,313	5.28	71.97
NZL		1,057	4.25	76.22
PHL		1,200	4.83	81.05
SGP		2,012	8.09	89.14
THA		1,500	6.03	95.17
VNM		1,200	4.83	100.00

Total		24,865	100.00	

-> regionname = Europe/Central Asia				
ISO 3166-1				
alpha-3				
country				
code		Freq.	Percent	Cum.

AND		1,004	3.88	3.88
ARM		1,223	4.73	8.61
CYP		1,000	3.87	12.48
CZE		1,200	4.64	17.12
DEU		1,528	5.91	23.03
GBR		2,609	10.09	33.13
GRC		1,200	4.64	37.77
KAZ		1,276	4.94	42.70
KGZ		1,200	4.64	47.35
NLD		2,145	8.30	55.64
ROU		1,257	4.86	60.51
RUS		1,810	7.00	67.51
SRB		1,046	4.05	71.55
SVK		1,200	4.64	76.20
TJK		1,200	4.64	80.84
TUR		2,415	9.34	90.18
UKR		1,289	4.99	95.16
UZB		1,250	4.84	100.00

Total		25,852	100.00	

-> regionname = Latin America/Caribbean				
ISO 3166-1				
alpha-3				
country				
code		Freq.	Percent	Cum.

ARG		1,003	5.75	5.75
BOL		2,067	11.85	17.60
BRA		1,762	10.10	27.71
CHL		1,000	5.73	33.44
COL		1,520	8.72	42.16
ECU		1,200	6.88	49.04
GTM		1,229	7.05	56.09
MEX		1,741	9.98	66.07
NIC		1,200	6.88	72.95

PER	1,400	8.03	80.98
PRI	1,127	6.46	87.44
URY	1,000	5.73	93.18
VEN	1,190	6.82	100.00

Total	17,439	100.00	
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-> regionname = Middle East/North Africa

ISO 3166-1			
alpha-3			
country			
code			

	Freq.	Percent	Cum.
EGY	1,200	12.11	12.11
IRN	1,499	15.13	27.25
IRQ	1,200	12.11	39.36
JOR	1,203	12.14	51.50
LBN	1,200	12.11	63.62
LBY	1,196	12.07	75.69
MAR	1,200	12.11	87.81
TUN	1,208	12.19	100.00

Total	9,906	100.00	
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-> regionname = North America

ISO 3166-1			
alpha-3			
country			
code			

	Freq.	Percent	Cum.
CAN	4,018	60.75	60.75
USA	2,596	39.25	100.00

Total	6,614	100.00	
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-> regionname = South Asia

ISO 3166-1			
alpha-3			
country			
code			

	Freq.	Percent	Cum.
BGD	1,200	20.25	20.25
IND	1,692	28.55	48.80
MDV	1,039	17.53	66.33
PAK	1,995	33.67	100.00

Total	5,926	100.00	
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-> regionname = Sub-Saharan Africa

ISO 3166-1			
alpha-3			
country			
code			

	Freq.	Percent	Cum.
ETH	1,230	24.86	24.86
KEN	1,266	25.59	50.44
NGA	1,237	25.00	75.44
ZWE	1,215	24.56	100.00

Total	4,948	100.00	
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1.2 var_des and Histograms

1.3 Interactions with financial satisfaction, class, and income

	a	b	c
freedom			
lt10k	0.00	0.00	0.00
10-100k	-0.11*	0.03	0.02
100-500k	-0.07	-0.10	0.06
gt500k	0.02	-0.00	-0.01
RECODE of satFin (financial satisfac- tion)=1	0.00		
RECODE of satFin (financial satisfac- tion)=2	0.69***		
RECODE of satFin (financial satisfac- tion)=3	1.53***		
lt10k × RECODE of satFin (financial satisfaction)=1	0.00		
lt10k × RECODE of satFin (financial satisfaction)=2	0.00		
lt10k × RECODE of satFin (financial satisfaction)=3	0.00		
10-100k × RE- CODE of satFin (financial satisfac- tion)=1	0.00		
10-100k × RE- CODE of satFin (financial satisfac- tion)=2	0.19***		
10-100k × RE- CODE of satFin (financial satisfac- tion)=3	0.12*		
100-500k × RE- CODE of satFin (financial satisfac- tion)=1	0.00		
100-500k × RE- CODE of satFin (financial satisfac- tion)=2	0.11+		
100-500k × RE- CODE of satFin (financial satisfac- tion)=3	0.13+		
gt500k × RE- CODE of satFin (financial satisfac- tion)=1	0.00		
gt500k × RE- CODE of satFin (financial satisfac- tion)=2	0.08		
gt500k × RE- CODE of satFin (financial satisfac- tion)=3	0.03		
trust	0.03	0.08***	0.07***
freq felt unsafe from crime at home	-0.12***	-0.18***	-0.18***
victim of a crime last year	-0.13***	-0.16***	-0.16***
age	0.02***	0.01*	0.01**
age2	-0.00***	-0.00	-0.00
male	0.01	0.01	-0.00
married or living together as mar- ried	0.01	0.05**	0.04*
Full time	0.00	0.00	0.00
Part time	-0.08**	-0.09**	-0.07*
Self employed	-0.02	-0.03	-0.01
Retired	-0.05	-0.00	0.02
Housewife	-0.21***	-0.20***	-0.18***
Students	-0.14***	-0.12**	-0.11**
Unemployed	-0.13***	-0.20***	-0.16***
Other	-0.24***	-0.27***	-0.26***
health	0.35***	0.47***	0.46***
How many chil- dren do you have	0.01+	0.01	0.01
religion important	0.04***	0.05***	0.05***
Lower class		0.00	
Working class		0.34***	
Lower middle class		0.38***	
Upp mid/upper		0.58***	
lt10k × Lower class		0.00	
lt10k × Working class		0.00	
lt10k × Lower middle class		0.00	
lt10k × Upp mid/upper		0.00	
10-100k × Lower		0.00	

2 Auxiliary results and sidenotes

2.1 Some graphs

fig 2 and 3

weird to think that more ineq and pov would produce more freedom/autonomy; rather i guess lax capitalist friendly regulation would produce more ineq and pov, but should also produce less autonomy/freedom on avg, but it doesn't, there is positive relationship

or maybe the other way round: more freedom/autonomy more ineq and pov

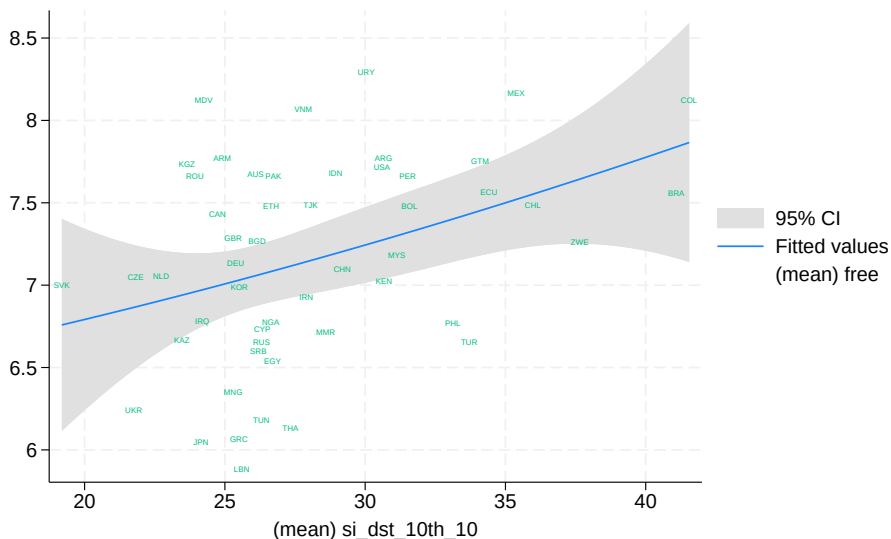


Figure 2: more ineq (inc share held by top 10perc, more autonomy—conservatives would like it!! and pretty strong corr .4

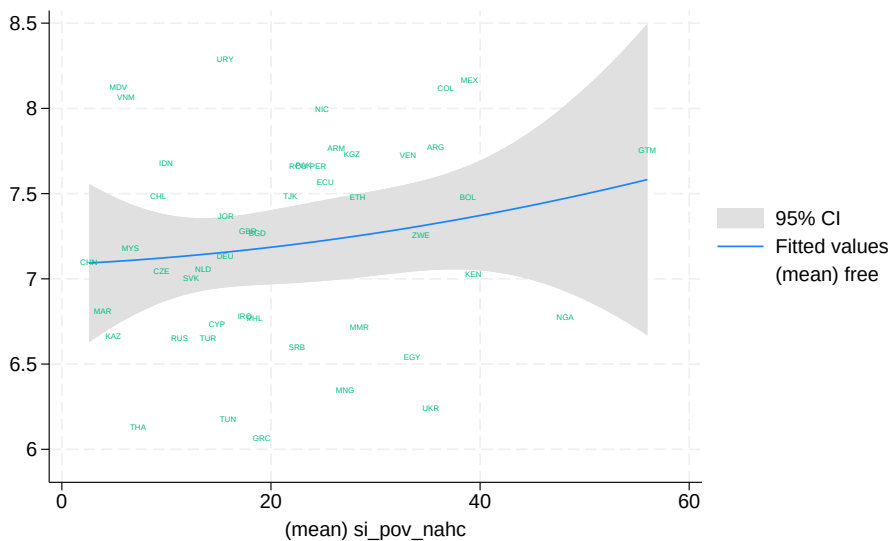


Figure 3: likewise with poverty, but here corr just .2

2.2 Literature

Newman (2020) makes some useful points that may be worth citing in full:

Social theory typically conceives of urban growth as associated with political freedom. [...] But not even in the most likely of cases did the city makes urban peasants free. Focusing on Mexico City, I argue that because rural-to-urban migrants became urban denizens by establishing squatter settlements, they entered into dependent relations with political elites, which reinforced a system of political dependency, or clientelist politics. [...] Mexico is, perhaps, the most iconic case. A large cross section of the peasantry rose in arms against landowning oligarchs in the insurrectionary phase of the Mexican Revolution (1910-1917), ultimately precipitating the wholesale reconstruction of the political order. Thereafter, peasants continued to mobilize for radical change, constituting a major obstacle to postrevolutionary governing elites who sought to consolidate control. [...] When a large and growing portion of rural-to-urban migrants live in squatter settlements, and therefore have little recourse to legal protection in residential matters, they almost inevitably grow dependent on political elites—in an arrangement known as “clientelism.” Urban concentration gives rise to clientelism.

```
. tabstat ls, by(lwd7) stat(mean sd) format(%9.1f)
```

Summary for variables: ls
Group variable: lwd7 (RECODE of lwd (do what you like))

lwd7	Mean	SD
0-4	5.6	2.7
2	7.6	2.3
3	7.6	1.8
4	8.0	1.5
5	7.8	1.9
6	8.2	1.5
7	8.9	1.5
Total	8.3	1.9

.9

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